

BACKGROUND: Diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI) are central to today's public discourse, guiding organizations in addressing historical and ongoing marginalization based on race, gender, sex, and other forms of systemic oppression. By dismantling exclusive practices and implementing equitable hiring, we create environments where individuals from diverse backgrounds can thrive.

RESEARCH: The Riverside County Board of Supervisors formally recognized [racism as a public health emergency](#) on August 4, 2020, citing its impact on housing, education, employment, transportation, and criminal justice. Following this, the board held three qualitative [listening sessions](#) in September and October 2020, where 44 speakers, mostly people of color and between the ages of full-time workers or college students, gave public testimony sharing their lived experiences and concerns about accessing services.

Since the resolution was passed, Riverside County has made significant strides in equity efforts. From hiring an Equity, Access, and Opportunity Officer, to releasing the [Emmy award-winning 'DEIA Stories' series](#), to establishing an equity task force, and reviewing internal policies and practices to address inequities. Each of these steps has brought the county closer to overcoming barriers and prioritizing diversity, equity, and inclusion.

In 2023, following the adoption of the resolution, an [internal staff survey](#) was launched to gather critical input from employees on the current and future direction of equity within the organization. At the time, the county had a total of 20,000 employees, 7,000 responded to the survey. **A striking 39% of respondents highlighted accessibility as a top priority, calling for leadership that is informed about injustices, actively working to enhance representation and improve internal communication on equity issues. This feedback reflected a clear and urgent call-to-action that we wanted to deliver on.**

PLANNING: Our goal for the Equity Lens was to create awareness across our workforce, provide departments with an opportunity to share their equity wins, and develop an additional avenue to uplift the diverse experiences of county employees. Our office established a quarterly internal newsletter, "The Equity Lens," in direct response to employees' requests, aiming to educate staff on equity efforts across the county's departments, resonate with the stories of their peers, keep them informed on departmental progress, and serve as an accountability tool to show that the county is fulfilling its resolution. Tangible **objectives** included:

1. Publish a new issue of The Equity Lens every quarter.
2. Ensure the publication reaches all 25,000 county employees in both English and Spanish.
3. Achieve a 33% open rate, totaling at least 11,000 opens.
4. Leverage other county department channels to boost distribution and increase the open rate.
5. Feature a different employee's experiences in each publication.
6. Increase the number of wins submitted by departments with each release to sustain engagement.

The target audience for the publication includes County employees, leadership, and contract agencies supporting equity efforts. **County data shows that of 25,000 employees, 14,527 are female, 8,300 are male, with the majority aged 46-50. Hispanic/Latino individuals make up 39% of the workforce, followed by 22% White, 8% Black, and 31% identifying as two or more races, unidentified, Asian, Native, or Indian.**

BUDGET: The publications were created by the Equity, Access, and Opportunity (EAO) Officer and two Senior Public Information Specialists, using Adobe Photoshop, Microsoft Word, a Canon R6 Mark II, and studio lighting. Each publication requires about 30 hours to produce, totaling 90 hours and an estimated \$6,000 for all three. They are distributed digitally and hosted on the county's DEIA [website](#).

IMPLEMENTATION: The Equity Lens were drafted, formatted, edited, and distributed by RivCo EO. **The design aimed to create a polished, magazine-like publication with eye-catching aesthetics and concise language to engage readers.**

Each publication featured an employee from the DEIA series, highlighting their story with a headshot and two-word title reflecting their experience with DEI. A message from the EAO Officer reinforced equity's importance in creating a diverse workplace. We showcased department wins, like RivCo Parks' efforts to remove economic barriers and RCIT's broadband plan to close the digital divide, highlighting their commitment to equity. In the third edition, we added a Q&A section to deepen the equity conversation and provided tips in the 'Strategic Insights' section on using equity data to advance departmental work.

Data drives equity efforts. The 'Data/Dashboard Update' section shared key county-wide data, including survey results that showed how employees' feedback helped shape equity goals, internal workforce diversity data in response to requests for more diversity, and county-wide [Healthy Places Index \(HPI\) data](#) to help employees see underserved areas within our region.

RESULTS AND EVALUATION: The results surpassed our expectations:

- We nearly hit our goal of releasing an edition every three months since launching the publication—May, July, and November 2024.
- Each edition reached all 25,000 county employees, plus 10,000 external subscribers, in both English and Spanish.
- All three publications achieved a total open rate of 11,000, with the last two surpassing our goal by reaching over 13,000 opens.
- We gained support from two departments for broader distribution—Public Health Equity included The Equity Lens in their monthly newsletter to 1,300 recipients, and the Department of Public Social Services sent it to their 6,000 employees.
- Each edition featured a different county employee, including a deputy director, assistant chief executive officer, and department director.
- The number of department wins grew with each edition, as leadership became more engaged in sharing their equity efforts. We also added a Q&A section to the final edition.

As a result, the Equity Lens publication has successfully created a consistent and informative channel that educated and engaged County employees on DEI efforts. The inclusion of employee stories, department achievements, and real-time data has strengthened the connection between leadership and staff, fostering a more inclusive culture. Please view the digital asset management portal [here](#).





THE EQUITY LENS

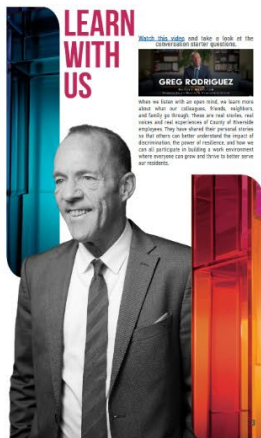
INTERNAL COMMUNICATIONS



INAUGURAL ISSUE



SPANISH LANGUAGE VERSIONS



INTERIOR LAYOUT



PRÓXIMOS EVENTOS 2024

FECHA	TEMÁTICA	LOCACIÓN
15 de mayo	Salud Pública	Salud Pública
22 de mayo	Salud Mental	Salud Mental
29 de mayo	Salud Infantil	Salud Infantil
5 de junio	Salud Maternal y Neonatal	Salud Maternal y Neonatal
12 de junio	Salud Geriátrica	Salud Geriátrica
19 de junio	Salud de la Mujer	Salud de la Mujer
26 de junio	Salud de la Familia	Salud de la Familia
3 de julio	Salud de la Comunidad	Salud de la Comunidad
10 de julio	Salud de la Población	Salud de la Población
17 de julio	Salud de la Fuerza de Trabajo	Salud de la Fuerza de Trabajo
24 de julio	Salud de la Educación	Salud de la Educación
31 de julio	Salud de la Cultura	Salud de la Cultura
7 de agosto	Salud de la Lengua	Salud de la Lengua
14 de agosto	Salud de la Religión	Salud de la Religión
21 de agosto	Salud de la Raza	Salud de la Raza
28 de agosto	Salud de la Etnia	Salud de la Etnia
4 de septiembre	Salud de la Sexualidad	Salud de la Sexualidad
11 de septiembre	Salud de la Género	Salud de la Género
18 de septiembre	Salud de la Diversidad	Salud de la Diversidad
25 de septiembre	Salud de la Inclusión	Salud de la Inclusión
2 de octubre	Salud de la Accesibilidad	Salud de la Accesibilidad
9 de octubre	Salud de la Participación	Salud de la Participación
16 de octubre	Salud de la Transparencia	Salud de la Transparencia
23 de octubre	Salud de la Responsabilidad	Salud de la Responsabilidad
30 de octubre	Salud de la Integridad	Salud de la Integridad
6 de noviembre	Salud de la Honestidad	Salud de la Honestidad
13 de noviembre	Salud de la Justicia	Salud de la Justicia
20 de noviembre	Salud de la Equidad	Salud de la Equidad
27 de noviembre	Salud de la Libertad	Salud de la Libertad
4 de diciembre	Salud de la Paz	Salud de la Paz
11 de diciembre	Salud de la Seguridad	Salud de la Seguridad
18 de diciembre	Salud de la Prosperidad	Salud de la Prosperidad
25 de diciembre	Salud de la Bienestar	Salud de la Bienestar
1 de enero	Salud de la Felicidad	Salud de la Felicidad

DATA/DASHBOARDS UPDATE

THE EQUITY QUESTIONNAIRE RESULTS



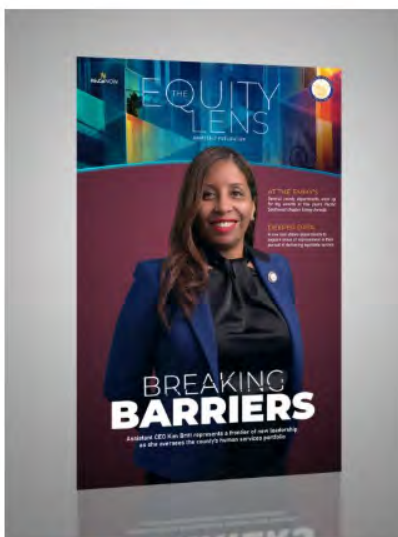


We invite you to explore The Equity Lens where you will find content that is inspiring, informative, and meaningful for conversation among colleagues. The Equity Lens serves as a valuable resource for enhancing engagement with the communities we serve. Please visit the publication below in both English and Spanish which includes a glimpse into how Riverside County is embedding equity into operations, sharing stories for learning, and providing insights from a comprehensive equity survey.

CLICK THE IMAGE BELOW TO VIEW



- [April 2024 Volume I - English](#)
- [April 2024 Volume I - Spanish](#)

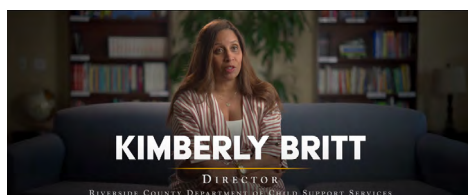


- [August 2024 Volume II- English](#)
- [August 2024 Volume II- Spanish](#)



- [November 2024 Volume III- English](#)
- [November 2024 Volume III- Spanish](#)

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FOR ADDITIONAL ASSETS, [CLICK HERE](#)

